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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (SEC)
MG5SECSDV300 - MEDIA MANAGEMENT

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyze (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

PART A: Very Short Answer
Answer any 5 questions. Each question carries 2 marks.

1. Identify the core focus of classical management theory.
Efficiency, organizational structure, standardization, and labor productivity

2. Define intellectual property (IP) in media organizations.
Intangible legal rights protecting creative human intellect, original expressions, and brand identities within media operations. **Copyrights:** Original scripts, broadcasts, music, photographs, and written content. **Trademarks:** Channel logos, brand names, mastheads, and slogans. **Patents & Trade Secrets:** Proprietary broadcasting technology, algorithms, and confidential operational methods.

3. Define resource planning in the context of media organizations.
The strategic identification, allocation, and scheduling of technical, financial, human, and time assets required to produce and distribute media content.

4. Identify two key factors media managers consider when scheduling content.
1: Audience Demographics & Dayparting: Matching program types with viewer/listener availability during specific hours (e.g., prime-time entertainment vs. morning news).

2: Advertiser Appeal & Competition: Capitalizing on peak ad-revenue slots and counter-programming against rival media channels.

5. Differentiate briefly between recruitment and selection.
Recruitment is the process of searching for and encouraging potential candidates to apply, whereas selection is the process of screening, evaluating, and hiring the best candidate.
Recruitment is a positive process because it aims to attract a large applicant pool, while selection is considered a negative process because it involves rejecting unsuitable applicants. Recruitment always precedes selection, whereas selection follows recruitment.

6. Identify two key legal authorities governing printers and publishers in India.

- **Registrar of Newspapers for India (RNI):** Statutory body under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting overseeing registration, titles, and circulation verification.
- **Press Council of India (PCI):** Statutory, quasi-judicial body maintaining press freedom and ethics under the Press Council Act, 1978.

7. Define media as an industry.

The commercial ecosystem involved in the large-scale creation, production, aggregation, and distribution of information, news, and entertainment content. Operates on a dual-product market model (selling content to audiences and selling audience attention to advertisers).

Encompasses print, broadcast (radio/TV), digital/online, and film sectors driven by technology, regulatory frameworks, and business economics.

PART B: Short Answer

Answer any 4 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

8. Role of ratings and audience feedback in commercial media broadcasting.

Audience Measurement & Metrics: Television Rating Points (TRP) / Target Rating Points, Listenership ratings (RAM), and digital metrics (views, click-through rates).

Revenue Generation: Ratings establish ad-rate cards; higher ratings directly attract premium advertisers and sponsorships.

Programming & Content Decisions: Determines show renewals, time-slot adjustments, cancellations, and format refreshes based on viewer preferences.

Audience Feedback Integration: Social media comments, focus groups, and call-in feedback aid in editorial alignment, crisis management, and viewer retention strategies.

9. How media managers distribute resources during breaking news.

Immediate Personnel Reallocation: Deployment of field reporters, camera crews, and mobile news gatherers (DSNG/OB units) to the event site instantly.

Studio & Production Realignment: Overriding scheduled programming; reallocating control rooms (PCR/MCR), anchors, and live graphics teams for continuous coverage.

Bandwidth & Technical Logistics: Securing satellite links, IP-cellular backpacks (LiveU), and cloud editing pipelines for low-latency transmission.

Financial & Safety Emergency Buffers: Tapping into contingency budgets for crew travel, emergency equipment rental, and field safety protocols.

10.Gulab Kothari's framework in *Newspaper Management in India*.

Harmonization of Management & Culture: Blends universal administrative principles (Fayol/Taylor) with regional Indian socio-cultural dynamics.

Editorial Independence vs. Commercial Realities: Treats the newspaper not merely as a profit center, but as a public trust carrying ethical responsibility toward society.

Regional Audience Centricity: Emphasizes hyper-local coverage, language nuances, and traditional community values over westernized corporate models.

Operational Flexibility: Advocates for flexible organizational structures suited to regional supply chain constraints, localized circulation networks, and regional ad-markets.

11.Budgeting process and financial planning unique to newspaper publishing.

Revenue Stream Forecasting: Projecting dual revenue streams: Advertising income (display, classifieds, government ads) and Circulation income (subscriptions, cover price sales).

Cost Center Structure: First-Copy Costs (Fixed): Editorial salaries, news gathering (wire services), photography, prepress, and administrative overheads.

Variable / Reproduction Costs: Newsprint paper stock (major expense driver), ink, printing machinery maintenance, electricity, and distribution commission.

Newsprint Cost Volatility Management: Buffering budgets against global paper price fluctuations, import duties, and currency exchange rates.

Circulation & Yield Optimization: Calculating net paid circulation vs. unsold copies (returns/waste paper realization).

12.Core functions of media management within a publishing or broadcast organization.

- **Planning:** Setting editorial policies, long-term content strategies, broadcast grids, and financial projections.
- **Organizing:** Structuring departments (editorial, production, sales, technical, marketing) and defining chains of command.
- **Staffing & Human Resources:** Recruiting specialized creative/technical talent, managing freelancer contracts, and handling shift rotas.
- **Directing & Coordinating:** Aligning daily workflows across newsrooms, studios, technical teams, and commercial departments.
- **Controlling & Monitoring:** Quality control, legal compliance, ratings tracking, audit verification (e.g., ABC/RNI), and budgetary control.

PART C: Essay

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 10 marks.

13.Three phases of production management: Pre-production, Production, and Post-production.

A. Pre-Production Phase (Planning & Preparation)

Concept Development: Scriptwriting, storyboarding, format finalization, and editorial approvals.

Resource Scheduling & Budgeting: Allocating funds, securing permits, copyright clearances, and talent hiring.

Logistics & Scouting: Location scouting, equipment checks, set design, and technical rehearsal scheduling.

B. Production Phase (Execution & Capture)

Content Creation: Live broadcasting, principal photography, filming, and audio recording.

On-Set Management: Coordinating director, floor manager, camera operators, sound technicians, and talent/anchors.

Time & Quality Control: Adhering to call sheets, managing shot lists, and ensuring technical standards (lighting, sound levels).

C. Post-Production Phase (Assembly & Delivery)

Editing & Assembly: Offline/online video editing, audio mixing/dubbing, color grading, and visual graphics/VFX addition.

Mastering & Quality Check: Technical compliance check (aspect ratios, broadcast loudness standards, frame rates).

Archiving & Distribution: Encoding for multi-platform delivery (TV transmission, OTT, web) and metadata tagging for archives.

D. Workflow & Coordination Importance

- Prevents cost overruns, missing transmission deadlines, and technical errors.
- Ensures seamless inter-departmental handoffs from creative teams to technical operators.

14. Core components of media business and resource management.

A. Resource Planning

Mapping creative human capital, technical gear, studio facilities, and transmission bandwidth. Utilizing capacity planning to avoid bottlenecking during peak production schedules.

B. Budgeting Mechanisms

Zero-Based Budgeting: Re-evaluating cost heads from scratch per project/season.

Capital Expenditure (CapEx) vs. Operational Expenditure (OpEx): Balancing infrastructure purchases (cameras, servers) against daily running costs.
Cost allocation across programming genres (news vs. entertainment).

C. Diverse Revenue Models

Advertising Model: Commercial spots, sponsorships, branded content, classifieds, and programmatic ad units.

Subscription / Paywall Models: Cable TV retransmission fees, digital paywalls, OTT monthly subscriptions.

Syndication & Licensing: Selling broadcast/distribution rights of owned IP to third-party markets or foreign networks.

D. Operational Oversight

Ensuring legal compliance (defamation, copyright, broadcasting codes).

Maintaining supply chain efficiency (newsprint distribution networks or digital CDN infrastructure).

15. Challenges of personnel management and departmental coordination in media enterprises.

A. Personnel Management Challenges

Creative vs. Corporate Culture Conflict: Managing tension between artistic freedom (journalists, directors) and business constraints (deadlines, budgets).
24/7 Work Environment & Burnout: Managing irregular shifts, high-stress newsroom environments, and employee turnover.
Gig Economy & Freelance Workforce: Handling hybrid workforces combining permanent staff, contract freelancers, and stringers.
Skill Obsolescence: Continuous retraining required for traditional media personnel adapting to digital/AI workflows.

B. Departmental Coordination Challenges

Silo Mentality: Misalignment between Editorial (content creators) and Commercial (ad sales/marketing) teams.

Deadline Pressure & Real-Time Handoffs: Friction during high-pressure handoffs between field reporting, desk editing, graphic design, and master control room (MCR).

Multi-Platform Convergence: Coordinating unified content creation across traditional print/TV outlets and social/digital platforms simultaneously.

A. Managerial Solutions

Clear cross-departmental communication protocols and integrated newsrooms.

Transparent KPI frameworks balancing creative quality with revenue goals.

B. Workflow & Coordination Importance

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